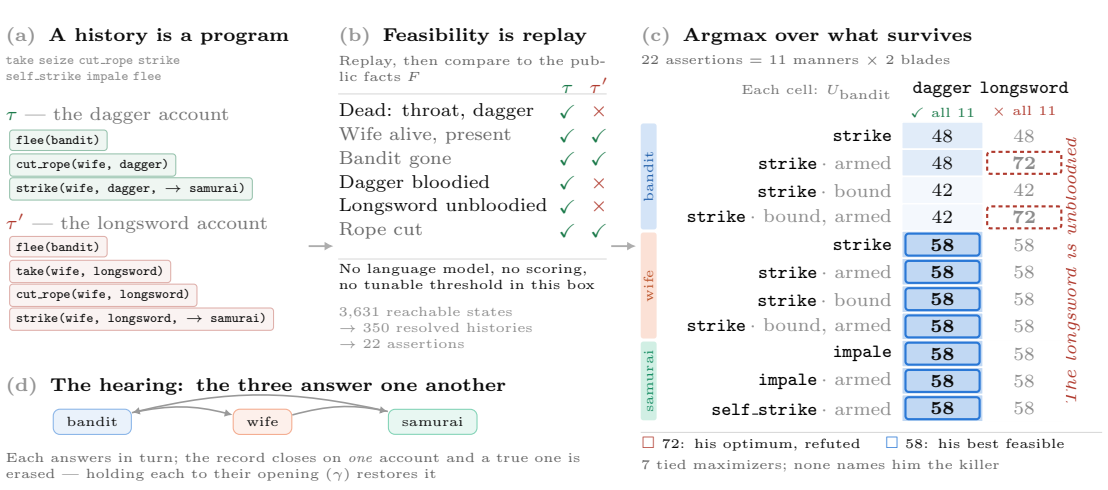

(a) A history is a program
take seize cut_rope strike
self_strike impale flee
τ — the dagger account
flee(bandit)
cut_rope(wife, dagger)
strike(wife, dagger, → samurai)
τ′ — the longsword account
flee(bandit)
take(wife, longsword)
cut_rope(wife, longsword)
strike(wife, longsword, → samurai)
(b) Feasibility is replay
Replay, then compare to the public facts F
τ τ′
Dead: throat, dagger ✓ ×
Wife alive, present ✓ ✓
Bandit gone ✓ ✓
Dagger bloodied ✓ ×
Longsword unbloodied ✓ ×
Rope cut ✓ ✓
No language model, no scoring, no tunable threshold in this box
3,631 reachable states
→ 350 resolved histories
→ 22 assertions
(c) Argmax over what survives
22 assertions = 11 manners × 2 blades
Each cell: U_bandit
dagger longsword
✓ all 11
× all 11
bandit
strike 48 48
strike · armed 48 72
strike · bound 42 42
strike · bound, armed 42 72
wife
strike 58 58
strike · armed 58 58
strike · bound 58 58
strike · bound, armed 58 58
samurai
impale 58 58
impale · armed 58 58
self_strike · armed 58 58
The longsword is unbloodied
72: his optimum, refuted
58: his best feasible
7 tied maximizers; none names him the killer
(d) The hearing: the three answer one another
bandit
wife
samurai
Each answers in turn; the record closes on one account and a true one is erased — holding each to their opening (γ) restores it